

Flowering plants

Flowers help plants reproduce. Many have eye-catching colors, sweet scents, and tasty nectar that entice pollinating animals, such as bees. Once the seeds are fertilized, they develop inside the fruit.



The bright colors of a bird-of-paradise flower attract nectar-seeking pollinators, such as sunbirds.

Bristlecone pines grow very slowly but live long. One—thought to be more than 4,800 years old—could be one of the oldest living things on the planet.



Ripe fruits are often filled with sweet juice—perfect for attracting sugar-loving animals who, by devouring the fruit, help scatter the seeds inside.



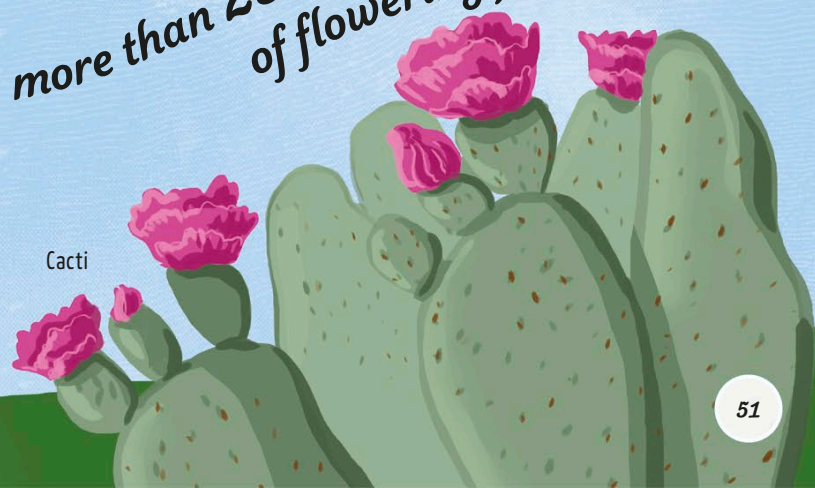
In springtime some plants, such as magnolias, produce flowers even before they sprout leaves.

Most plants need their pollen to be carried to other flowers. However, some—such as this Antarctic pearlwort—can pollinate themselves.

There are more than 250,000 species of flowering plant.



Sunflowers



Cacti